



C.R.E NOTES

FORM FOUR



SUMMARIZED FORM FOUR NOTES



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CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION TO CHRISTIAN ETHICS

Christian ethics

The word ethics comes from a Greek Term Ethics which means custom, or conduct.

Ethics are moral principles, which influence a persons behavior.

Ethics are defined as the systematic study of human actions and behavior.

We use ethics to judge, determine and assess the right and wrong of human behavior.

Morals refer to human character, which is the inclination to behave in one- way or another.

Ethics is the study of morals and they determine and influence personal and societal behavior

Christian ethics is the study of human conduct or behavior from a Christian point of view.

Basis of Christian ethics/Sources of Christians ethics

I . Human reason and experience

These are internal thoughts that guide us when we are making decisions and taking actions.

We use our minds and thoughts when confronted by situations.

They also rely on internal thoughts in their life experiences.

Internal guides

They include;

a. Conscience

This is our inner self that tells us and lets us know what is right and wrong.

There are four types of consciences; doubtful, sensitive, certain and perplexed conscience..

b. Human Experiences

These are internal and external guides

When confronted by situations, Christians use their minds i.e. human reason and their life experiences in making decisions.

They rely on internal guides, (Human reason) and experience (external guides)

Internal guides



Conscience Mind, aspect of knowing right or wrong. When right, there's approval when wrong it registers guilt.

When doubtful of the morality of an action we should not do it

If conscience is perplexed, then make a decision. A decision should be based on a certain conscience.

c. Knowledge and free will

To make a decision one should have

- ✓ Facts about the act, its aims, circumstances.
- ✓ One should be free to perform
- ✓ A decision ought to be thoughtful

d. Intuition — inner feeling, insight

It's an internal moral sense to do good or avoid evil. Intuition is important in situations that require quick and immediate action.

Feelings are subjective e.g. "it feels good to do so this, hence will do..." it can be dangerous to make decisions purely based on feelings especially in marriage friendship etc.

Eternal guides

Experience, Guides here include authoritative persons such as parents, teachers, police, civil leaders and religious leaders.

Rules from secular, religions, and African traditional culture are part of external guides.

2. The Bible

The Bible guides Christian behaviour. God communicates to his people through the Bible.

The Bible offers answers to questions in relation to the life of a Christian.

They are mostly found in the teachings of Jesus and the ten commandments, sermon on the mountain

Christians are also encouraged to have Faith The virtues encouraged include generosity, love, kindness, faithfulness, patience, humility, peace, mercy, loyalty etc.

Today, there are ethical issues not found in the bible e.g. HIV / AIDS, sexual and reproductive health rights, contraceptives, abortion, globalization, cloning, environmental degradation, genetically modified foods, terrorism, international trade etc.

This gives reason and other sources basis of Christian ethics in addition to the Bible.



3. Christian community — church

Church leadership can make decisions, which touch on their followers. They guide people on ethical issues e.g. politics, land, justice, abortion, contraception etc.

Church organizations give rules on those conduct of their members.

4. Natural law

The awareness that one has to choose good and avoid evil

If one studies human nature and reflects upon it he/she will discover natural laws of human behaviour

Natural law, natural rights such as right to education, life own property many etc. are incorporated into the constitution of any nation.

The constitution then guides the behaviour of list citizens; Christians being citizens of a country are guided in their behaviour by the constitution.

5. Situation ethics

One should reason out the rightness or wrongness of an act. The rightness or wrongness of an act depends on its uniqueness, the circumstances

Christians are warned against making decisions based on circumstances or the situation e.g. a pregnant student seeking abortion as the option so as to continue with education.

6. Gods revelation

God reveals himself to people through prophets, natural events, the law, dreams and visions. Through such ways God guides Christian on how they should approach certain issues. Gods revelation does not contradict with the Bible.

Christian values that enhance the creation of a just society

The values that enhance the creation of a just society include;

a. Love

Love is an important value in creating a just society

God demonstrated His selfless love by giving His only son to die for the sake of mankind

Christians should sacrifice their love by helping the disadvantaged members in the society without seeking for reward



b. Honesty/reliability faithfulness

Honesty is an important moral value because it makes us dependable and trusted

God command us to be honest with ourselves and in our dealings with other people

When we are honest, we are also reliable and dependable

c. Justice/fairness

Justice is an important moral value.

Christians should follow Gods teachings on justice by treating all people as equal since all are created in Gods image and likeness.

d. Respect

Christians are expected to show respect to their fellow human beings

They are expected to respect God and themselves through the things they do.

They are expected to respect their work and resources under their care.

e. Humility

Christians should uphold the moral value of humility

They should not think highly of themselves

They should humble themselves by serving others without reservation.

f. Perseverance/persistence

Christians should be persistent in their faith in Jesus Christ

They should endure persecutions and suffering on account of their faith in God.

They should be persistent in their responsibilities by working hard for Jesus Christ and their communities.

g. Chastity

Christians should remain chaste by not engaging in immoral sexual activities

They should honour God for their bodies are the temple of the holy spirit.

Life Skills

Life skills are abilities that help people to develop positive behaviour.



They help people deal effectively with the demands and challenges of every day's life

Life skills enable an individual to live with oneself and making effective decisions.

They include the following;

1. Critical thinking

Critical thinking is important in shaping our independent thinking and judgement

We should apply critical thinking in everything we do.

One should reason and weigh the options i.e. consequences of an action taken.

2. Creative thinking

God has given us the gift of creative thinking

We should use it to develop ourselves and life of others.

We should approach problems with a critical mind.

3. Decision making

It involves weighing the options and arriving at the right decision

We should make right decisions so that we can live fulfilled lives

It's important to study a situation before making a decision

We should only make decisions that are beneficial to our lives and that of other people

4. Self-esteem

People with high self-esteem are confident and focussed.

They aim at achieving set goals, and are therefore result oriented.

We should work hard to build our self-esteem and self-worth.

5. Assertiveness

Assertive people have a high level of self-esteem, self-worth and confidence

They are honest with themselves and express their feelings and desires.

Importance of life skills

Life skills help an individual to;



1. They help people to live positively and actively
2. To practice healthy behaviour and inter personal relationships
3. Assess and avoid risky behaviour
4. Avoid risky behaviour
5. Contribute in making a just society
6. Set goals in life and achieve them
7. Build self-esteem and self confidence

CHAPTER 2

HUMAN SEXUALITY

Definition of Human sexuality

Human sexuality is that which makes us male or female.

It is our biological or physiological differences associated with the state of being male or female.

Besides the biological make up, we have an emotional side, which includes our attitudes, and feelings. Females are said to be more emotional and talkative than males.

Human sexuality is also in our brain and mind and it is what makes us human beings.



Gender roles play a great part in shaping our human sexuality. There are different gender roles for males and females in our society.

Christian teaching on human sexuality

Males and females are God's creation. Men and women were created for many reasons. These are to be fruitful and to multiply and for companionship.

In Genesis we learn that men and women share the image of God because God intended man and woman to play complementary roles and both are equal before God.

Sex in marriage is a sign of love and it is sacred. In marriage man / and woman become one flesh. Both of them have the ability to control their sexual desires.

Christian teaching forbids: sex before marriage, adultery or unfaithfulness, and other unnatural sexual behaviours like lesbianism, homosexuality or being gay, and incest.

God created human body and it is to be kept holy. Chastity is encouraged while unfaithfulness in marriage is discouraged. Husbands / wives are to respect one another and give to each other in mutual love.

Traditional African understanding of human sexuality

Human sexuality is highly valued in traditional African communities. It is understood in terms of marriage and parenthood.

Procreation was the sole purpose of sex. Sex was to be practiced in marriage and it was regarded as another sacred duty.

Adultery was discouraged and offenders punished. Irresponsible sexual relationships were forbidden.

Virginity before marriage was highly valued. If a girl lost her virginity before marriage, she was treated with scorn and punishment. If a boy impregnating a girl, he was fined.

In traditional African society it was a taboo to discuss openly sex matters.

Grandparents taught sex education to their grandchildren. Sex education was taught during initiation stages.

Free mixing of girls and boys was not allowed except under supervision. Girls were married off immediately after initiation to avoid temptation of engaging in pre-marital sex.

To reinforce self — discipline in relationships between the opposite sexes the African traditional society instilled the fear of supernatural curses through myths, taboos and rules.

Marital status. Husbands and wives were expected to relate to each other, their parents, and in laws according to the community customs.



Conflicts between a husband and a wife were resolved through intervention of relatives.

There are specific chores and duties for either male or female in African traditional societies.

Roles were therefore according to gender. Boys went hunting, herding, while girls fetched firewood, and helped in cooking.

African teachings on male-female relationships

Gender differences were evident when a child was born. For example, baby boys were welcomed by five ululations while girls were welcomed by three ululations.

At an early age, girls and boys would mix freely as they played together. Mature boys and girls however, were restricted from mixing freely without supervision by elders. But there was gender identification.

The boys identified with their fathers and other male adults, while girls identified themselves with their mother and other female adults.

At the adolescent stage; 13 — 18 years education was given to the adolescents and intensified at initiation stage. Boys and girls were taught traditional rules, and secrets of the society during initiation.

Learning was informal. Knowledge was communicated through songs, stories and riddles among other forms of presentations. All adults acted as parents to the young ones.

Men were socialized to be superior, while women were socialized to accept their subordinate position and role. Everyone knew and accepted what he/she was culturally supposed to do.

Division of labour was based on sex. In the African communities, despite their differences, there were many common customary roles, rules, regulations, taboos and beliefs that governed the practices related to male — female relationships from early childhood to old age.

These traditional African practices relating to male — female relationships existed at various levels. In all of them, man held superior positions when compared to those of women.

Old women and men were accorded respect. They were consulted for advice and counsel. Kinship system was emphasized.

Christian teaching on male- female relationships

The husband is the head of the house and should love his wife like Christ loved the church. Once a wife is loved, she should submit to her husband.



Both male and female are equal and co — creators with God. Adam and Eve were created to complement each other. Likewise, men and women should love each other.

Jesus taught that each man should have one wife and vice versa.

Once married, the husband's body belongs to the wife and hers belong to him. Wife and husband should avoid immorality.

Males and females are to relate freely. But the youth are to avoid the temptations of sex.

There are no specific chores or duties for either male or female.

Relationship between sexes should be governed by love, chastity, respect, self-control, and self-discipline.

Parents are to love their children, while children are to obey and honour their parents. Parents are asked to bring up their children in a Godly way.

CHAPTER 3

RESPONSIBLE SEXUAL BEHAVIOUR

Christian teaching on responsible human sexuality

Christianity teaches us about responsible sexual behaviour. Being responsible means that one is exercising self — control or self-discipline in matters of sexual behaviour.

Self-discipline is necessary when we have a relationship with the opposite sex (1 Cor. 7: 9 | Peter 5:). It is called responsible sexual behaviour, which is obedience to God's commands.

Christians promote healthy social relationship between boys and girls, men and women, and husbands and wives. Responsible sex is between male and female. Sexual intercourse is allowed only between married couples (1 Cor. 7: 3 — 5). Married couples are obliged to be sexually faithful to one another (Heb. 13: 4) adultery is condemned (Exodus 25: 14).

Relationship between a husband / wife should be one of respect, faithfulness, love, care, mercy, submission, tolerance, and forgiveness.

Christian teaching on irresponsible sexual behaviour

There are many irresponsible sexual behaviours. They include among others all acts and forms of: perversion, misuse, and abuse of sex, incest, rape, fornication, adultery, homosexuality, lesbianism or gay, prostitution, concubine, masturbation, bestiality and child marriages among others.



These irresponsible sexual behaviours are against God's will for humanity. Christians are to shun irresponsible sexual behaviour. This is because their bodies are the temples of the Holy Spirit. Thus whatever Christians do with their bodies, it should be for the glory of God.

Incest

sexual relationship between people who are closely related by blood. For example, sex between a brother/sister, father / daughter.

Incest is condemned in the Bible. It was punishable by death in the Old Testament. Leviticus 18:6 — 8.

Effects of incest

- ✓ Undermines the relationships between members of a family as it brings shame and guilt
- ✓ incest destroys relationships within the family and can lead to breaking up of a marriage.
- ✓ Incest destroys self-esteem, self — respect, and dignity of the victim.
- ✓ Incest can lead to pregnancy, and abortion.
- ✓ It can lead to infections with sexually transmitted diseases S.T.I.s and HIV / AIDS.

Rape

Is forcing another person to have sexual intercourse without his or her consent.

It is sexual violence and a crime against humanity.

It is also a denial, and a violation of human rights of the victims who are sexually assaulted.

Rape is an expression of hatred toward the opposite sex.

In traditional African society rape was abhorred and culprits were punished by death.

Effects of Rape

- ✓ Rape may result in pregnancy
- ✓ Serious physical injuries and
- ✓ May contract both the STIs, and HIV / AIDS.
- ✓ The victim is traumatized, and ashamed of self.
- ✓ The victim suffers from guilt, loneliness, humiliation, stress disorders, and depression among



- ✓ May lose trust in the opposite sex.
- ✓ These sufferings can lead to suicide and death

Fornication

This is consensual sexual intercourse between unmarried people.

It is condemned by both African and Christian teachings and punishment in ATS

In the Old Testament, men were forced to marry the girl. Jesus said that fornication was due to people's evil thoughts.

Abstinence for the youth is encouraged and preached

Why the youth engage in pre — marital sex.

- ✓ Sexual curiosity,
- ✓ Proving manhood,
- ✓ Human weakness,
- ✓ Lack of self-control,
- ✓ Testing fertility, fear of being jilted / rejected
- ✓ Commercial sex for money
- ✓ Copying acts in the print and electronic media,
- ✓ Frustrations,
- ✓ Drug abuse,
- ✓ Bribe to get a job, and
- ✓ Permissiveness in the society

Effects of Fornication

- ✓ Some of these are having children out of wedlock
- ✓ Feelings of distrust, guilt, and hurt;
- ✓ Contracting STIs and HIV/AIDS;
- ✓ Loss of self-respect; early and
- ✓ Forced marriage and abortion.



Adultery

Adultery is having sex outside marriage with a person with whom one is not married to.

Adultery is caused by

- ✓ lack of self — control,
- ✓ sexual dissatisfaction,
- ✓ long periods of wife and husband separation,
- ✓ sexual dysfunction and vengeance by an initially faithful spouse

Effects of Adultery

- ✓ Can lead to divorce,
- ✓ Abortion,
- ✓ STI, HIV/AIDS,
- ✓ Domestic violence,
- ✓ Murder (death) and
- ✓ Psychological problems

Prostitution

This is the practice of giving sexual pleasure for money or other material benefits. A prostitute can either be male or female. Prostitutes are referred to as commercial — sex workers.

There are factors leading to prostitution. These are

- ✓ Economic reasons such as unemployment, poverty,
- ✓ Rejection of a girl at home,
- ✓ Drug abuse,
- ✓ Stress, anger, anxiety, frustrations in the family and
- ✓ Pornography.

Effects of Prostitution

- ✓ It can lead to break up of marriage, and family.
- ✓ It lowers a persons dignity
- ✓ Can lead to unplanned pregnancies,



- ✓ School dropouts;
- ✓ Infections such as STIs and HIV /AIDS and
- ✓ Improper use of family resources

The church condemns prostitution because it defiles the body, which is a temple of the Holy Spirit. Its sexual immorality. Gal 5: 19 — 21.

Homosexuality/ Gay/ Lesbianism

This is sex between people of the same sex for example; man and man (gayism), woman and woman (lesbianism).

Homosexuality is a common practice in modern world. It is also a church problem.

Reasons for condemning homosexuality

- ✓ God created a male and a female. Read, Genesis 1:28.
- ✓ sex is sacred.
- ✓ Homosexuality is an unnatural relationship, which lowers human dignity.
- ✓ It does not provide sexual fulfilment (as traditionally)
- ✓ Homosexuality is illegal in Kenya.

Effects of homosexuality

- ✓ It is a threat to procreation.
- ✓ It promotes loose short-term informal relationships
- ✓ Promotes HIV / AIDS

Divorce

In the contemporary society, divorce is sought after or allowed because of: unfaithfulness in marriage or adultery; domestic violence; misuse of family resources; childlessness; in-law interference and alcohol abuse.

Legal reasons for divorce

According to the laws of Kenya, divorce is allowed under the following reasons;

- ✓ Adultery; if a man deserts his wife
- ✓ If a partner becomes insane; and
- ✓ Domestic violence for example, physical, and psychological torture.

Christian teaching about divorce

Christians discourage divorce because marriage is a permanent status.



Church discourages divorce because of its adverse effects. Some denominations allow divorce if there is adultery.

God hates divorce. Married couples should remain faithful to each other

Effects of divorce

- ✓ strained relationships,
- ✓ children suffering psychologically, and experiences of rejection.
- ✓ A divorcee faces social stigma, rejection, and isolation.
- ✓ If parents separate, they create single parent families.
- ✓ These families suffer from economic hardships and feelings of failure and inadequacy.

Abortion

Is termination of pregnancy before the foetus is capable of independent life.

There are two types of abortions.

- ✓ Spontaneous abortion or miscarriage.
- ✓ Induced abortion, which is deliberate and illegal in Kenya.

Causes of abortion

- ✓ Pregnancy due to rape and incest.
- ✓ If the mother believes that the unborn child will be a burden.
- ✓ If the mother lacks economic resources to take care of the baby.
- ✓ If the mother is in school, and she cannot look after the baby and continue with her education.
- ✓ Medical personnel may abort a deformed foetus
- ✓ In order to save the life of the mother if it is in danger.

Why Christians condemn abortion

- ✓ Christians view of abortion as murder (Exodus20: 13).
- ✓ Christian view is that the body is the temple of the Holy Spirit.
- ✓ God is the giver of life and He alone has the right to take it away.
- ✓ Abortion carries with it stigma



Effects of abortion

- ✓ Abortion can cause infertility on a woman
- ✓ Ectopic pregnancy
- ✓ Destruction of a woman's body parts
- ✓ Foetal malformation
- ✓ Risk of the mother bleeding to death and destruction of uterus.
- ✓ The mother may experience in future still births,
- ✓ Miscarriages, risk of barrenness;
- ✓ Failed abortions leading to deformed babies and psychological problems
- ✓ Can lead to stress and depression.

Sexually transmitted Diseases (STDs)

There are many diseases passed from one person to the other through sex.

These are gonorrhoea, syphilis, herpes genitals, hepatitis B, chlamydia, trichomoniasis, HIV/AIDS.

HIV / AIDS

This is human immune deficiency virus (HIV) that causes acquired immune deficiency syndrome (AIDS) condition. Syndrome refers to many symptoms.

HIV is transmitted largely through

- ✓ Sex with an infected partner;
- ✓ Through blood transfusion
- ✓ Sharing sharp objects with infected persons
- ✓ From an infected mother to the unborn child.

The signs / symptoms of AIDS

- ✓ Manifestations of symptoms of the opportunistic infections e.g. tuberculosis.
- ✓ Persistent coughs,
- ✓ Loss of weight,
- ✓ Oral thrush,
- ✓ Loss of appetite, and
- ✓ Diarrhoea.



Churches encourage Christians to be compassionate to HIV/AIDS affected people, and to support the infected and the affected individuals like the orphans, widows, and widowers.

Effects of HIV / AIDS

- ✓ Recurrent illness due to opportunistic infections.
- ✓ There is also stigmatization.
- ✓ Some individuals have feelings of guilt, anger, denial and depression.
- ✓ The sick persons have to look for extra finances to care for their health.
- ✓ They have the burden for medications, and special diet.
- ✓ HIV/aids has no cure and leads to death
- ✓ Parents die and leave their children as orphans.

Gonorrhoea

caused by a bacterium called Neisseria gonorrhoea Its symptoms appear 4 days after infection.

Symptoms

- ✓ burning sensation when passing urine
- ✓ pain or discomfort in the genitals
- ✓ sticky discharge or pus in the vagina or through the urethra.

Gonorrhoea is curable if treated early.

Effects of Gonorrhoea

- ✓ The disease damages a womans fallopian tubes leading to infertility; and a mans epididymis leading to sterility.
- ✓ An infected expectant mother can infect her new-born baby with gonorrhoea.
- ✓ The disease may affect the eyes of the unborn child causing blindness.
- ✓ Gonorrhoea can also cause inflammation of joints, the heart and liver.

Syphilis

Primary syphilis may show up in the form of a sore or a wound in the genitals a few days after infection. The wound heals by itself without treatment after some time.

Syphilis infection may take several years about 7 years before its symptoms re appear.



Symptoms

- ✓ a painless sore or pimple on the mans penis or womans vulva; and swelling of the glands in the groin.

Other symptoms, which may appear later, are

- ✓ Skin rashes, and sores either in the face armpits, under breasts, mouth or throat.

Effects of Syphilis

- ✓ Damage to the heart, brain and the nervous system.
- ✓ This disease can lead to madness and death of the victim.
- ✓ If a child is infected while in the womb, or during birth, the brain maybe damaged.
- ✓ The child may have either physical deformities or the infected mother may give stillbirths

Herpes genital

A sexual disease caused by a virus. It creates wounds in the genitals. A pregnant woman can transmit the infection to her new-born baby during delivery. This disease can be controlled although there is not an effective treatment.

Effects Herpes genitals.

- ✓ Infection can cause severe brain damage;
- ✓ cancer of the neck of the womb.
- ✓ If a woman is pregnant, the disease can cause death of the baby.
- ✓ The wounds and sores exposes the sick person to HIV /AIDS infections.

Hepatitis B

virus causes Hepatitis B. It is transmitted through sex, injections by unsterilized needles and contact with contaminated blood. The infection does not show on the genitals.

Signs and symptoms

- ✓ Yellowness of the eyes (jaundice) due to liver damage and
- ✓ Pain around the upper abdomen.

Effects of Hepatitis B

- ✓ This disease damages the liver and may lead to death of the infected person.

It has a vaccine, but not treatment.



Other consequences of irresponsible sexual behaviours

1. These are death,
2. Unplanned pregnancies leading to street children,
3. School dropouts especially girls
4. Psychological problems related to irresponsible sexual behaviour. These include: stress, depression, self — pity, withdrawal, aggressiveness, and violence.

CHAPTER 4

MARRIAGE

Definition of marriage

Marriage is a binding legal union between a man and a woman who agree to have a lasting relationship as husband/wife.

Meaning of marriage

Marriage involves other members of the community hence it is a social and community affair. Marriage is meant to be a permanent union.

Marriage is a community requirement in which everyone in the community participates.

Each person is expected to undergo marriage because it is a rite of passage.

Marriage gives a person, a high social status and prestige in the community.

Marriage is also a covenant between a man and a woman that should not be broken.

Once married, a couple is allowed to have sexual relationship, and companionship.

Marriage is an expression of and fulfilment of mutual love and comfort.

It enhances unity; social prestige, and respect in society.

Purpose of marriage is sexual fulfilment; cultural and social requirement; obligation to build a family; and procreation although children are a gift from God.

Various forms of marriages in Kenya include; Church marriages, Civil marriages, Customary marriages, Islamic marriages and Hindu marriages,

Traditional African understanding of marriage.

Marriage is a duty/a must/compulsory

Failure to marry means the person has rejected society and the society rejects him in turn.

Those who do not marry are considered as sub-human or lawbreakers.



Marriage is God ordained.

Young boys and girls are prepared for this sacred institution during initiation.

They are taught everything pertaining to marriage e.g. Sex.

Children cement the marriage children were important because;

1. They promote social status of their parents.
2. They cement a bond of unity between husband / wife.
3. They are a source of labour, and wealth.
4. They are heirs to the family wealth

Marriage involves other members of the community i.e. Community affair.

Marriage is a permanent union divorce and separation were not allowed.

Divorce and separation was allowed under certain circumstances like;

1. circumstances of adultery,
2. witchcraft,
3. laziness,
4. cruelty and
5. disrespect of wife. /husband

Each person is expected to undergo marriage because it is a rite of passage.

Marriage gives a person, a high social status and prestige in the community

The wife is subordinate to the husband but had no rights

The wife was inherited by one of her husbands brother

If a wife died, the man would marry the sister of his dead wife.

The ancestors are invoked to bless the marriage

Polygamy is allowed by the African traditional religion and served the following;

1. The first wife is barren;
2. Ensures that all women have husbands;
3. Prevents infertility;
4. Provides extra labour in farms.
5. A polygamous man has a higher status because many wives symbolize wealth.



Christian Teaching about Marriage

Christians teach that marriage is sacred and that; a divine institution, ordained God.

God started it when he created Adam and Eve. Marriage should therefore be monogamous

Marriage is permanent as God protects marriages.

The woman should submit to the husband to love the wife as Christ loved the church.

Church teaches respect of each other.

Marriage is complete even without children

it is between a male and a female.

Marriage is not obligatory and it ends when one partner dies.

One can choose to remain unmarried in order to serve God; celibacy

Secular approaches to marriage

In the modern world, some people choose not to marry for personal reasons.

Some people have children without getting married while others opt to have a marriage without children.

Husband and wife are equal. Monogamy is practiced for economic reasons.

In some families, women are the heads of the family.

Choosing a partner is an individual act and not communal.

In marriage traditional qualities of a good partner such as industrious, honesty, and hospitality are not considered.

The modern society values external beauty, financial status and social status.

As a result, there is a high rate of marriage, separation, and divorce.

At times young people fail to be married in church.

There is no formalization of marriages/come—we-stay marriage.

Christians preparation and approach to marriage

Christians organize youth seminars, and rallies to teach the youth how to choose marriage partners and how to treat wife / husbands; care for the children; behave towards in laws; acquire wealth (men); and head a family.

Youth are taught to avoid sexual intimacy before marriage. Those intending to marry are encouraged to go for pre-marital counselling.



During counselling, they are informed that love is the most important bond of unity in marriage. Church encourages partners to go for HIV /AIDs test before marriage.

Wedding ceremony is conducted in church where the couple exchange vows in front of a congregation

A church leader e.g. pastor or priest joins the marriage after the couple has shown commitment.

Choice of a marriage partner

There are many ways of identifying a marriage partner.

- ✓ Arrangement by parents. If not one can make an individual decision and choose a wife or husband.
- ✓ Through an intermediary or third party.

In African traditional polygamous marriages, the first wife identified a wife for her husband.

Girls would be given out to a chief as a gift

Preparation and approach to marriage in the African Traditional society

Courtship varied from community to community.

Courtship is the period between engagement and wedding ceremony.

During courtship premarital sex is forbidden.

Courtship was important in A.T.S because;

1. The man and woman got to know each other better before marriage.
2. It was a period when girls/boys were instructed in family life education.
3. It was also a period for linking the two marrying families.
4. The couple had time to learn about one another's character, and know their families.
5. It is a symbol (sign) of the girl's presence in her home (maternal home).
6. The families had an opportunity to check if the marrying couple was related
7. Courtship gives time to the two families to negotiate and pay the bride wealth or dowry.

Bridal Wealth

Dowry, bride price are all expressions of partnership. The family of the man pays dowry to the family of the woman.



Dowry is paid in different forms. E.g. livestock (poultry, pigs, camels, cows, goats and sheep), beer, grain, jewellery and clothes among others.

Importance of dowry

1. It acts as a compensation for the girls labour in her home.
2. Seals the marriage covenant.
3. It is a public expression of appreciation for the coming of a new wife into the mans family.
4. It promotes friendship and cements relationship between families.
5. It shows commitment and seriousness of the future husband.
6. After dowry payment, the woman belongs to her husband.

Bride price payment is accompanied by marriage ceremonies.

Celibacy as an alternative to marriage

Celibacy is a Latin word Coelebes meaning bachelor.

Celibacy refers to the unmarried state.

It is a gift from God. It is practised for the sake of dedicating ones life to serve God.it gives enough time to serve God

It is widely practised in the Roman catholic church

Those who cannot manage celibacy can get married to avoid temptations when serving God.

Leaders like Bishops, priests, nuns dedicate their lives to serve God by not marrying.

There are secular reasons for celibacy which include;

- ✓ To peruse higher education and scientific research and demanding careers
- ✓ Poor health, HIV /AIDS, mental illness, psychological and emotional problem
- ✓ Lack of guidance and counselling
- ✓ Discouragement from fallen marriages
- ✓ Economic indolence on part of some women
- ✓ Parental interference

CHAPTER 5

THE FAMILY

Meaning of family

Family is the basic social unit of human society.

This basic unit is extended to include relatives bound together by blood, marriage, friendship, and adoption.

They are all members of the family. In Kenya, there are many types of families.



Types of families

Nuclear family

It is made up of parents and their children. It is father, mother, and children.

Common type of family today due to hard economic times, Christianity advocates it and, and fear of HIV/AIDS and other diseases,

Advantages of nuclear families

1. The man is able to give undivided attention to his wife and children e.g. family resources.
2. There is sharing of mutual love, and peace in the home.
3. It is economical to manage one family.
4. There is little competition for attention, less strife, quarrels and stress.
5. It is easier to monitor the behaviour of a few children.

Polygamous family

Made up of father, mothers/wives and children,

Was common in the African Traditional societies but not common in the contemporary society.

This type of family was considered important in the Traditional African Society due to social economic reasons, security and solving problems related to having children.

Disadvantages

- 1) The man gives divided attention to his wives and children example family resources.
- 2) There is no sharing of mutual love, and at times, there is no peace in the home.
- 3) It is not economical to manage one family especially with the high cost of living.
- 4) There is little competition for attention, less strife, quarrels and stress.
- 5) It is not easier to monitor the behaviour of a few children.

Single parent family

Comprises of one parent, and children.

Single parent families are created by several circumstances.

1. Separation of parents due to going to another country and failing to come back.
2. Divorced parents may decide not to marry again.
3. When a girl gets pregnant and the boy does not marry her.



4. Death of a spouse. The remaining parent may decide not to remarry.
5. When some mothers decide to have children without marriage.
6. Imprisonment of one partner for a long time.

Extended family

Made up of father, mother, children, uncles, aunts, and cousins. This is the common family type in traditional African communities.

Children led family

This happens when parents die and the 1st born takes care of brothers and sisters including cousins.

Grandparent headed family

The HIV/AIDs epidemic has introduced this type of family where grandparents take care of their grandchildren due to the death of both parents especially the mother due to HIV / AIDS disease.

This scourge has made many children orphans.

In other cases, parents go for further studies abroad and leave their children with their parents.

Traditional African understanding of a family

In African societies creation of a family is through marriage, and subsequent procreation.

Family is viewed as a sacred institution in African society.

The African traditional family includes the ancestors, the unborn children and the living.

An African traditional family has obligations and duties. These were

1. offering sacrifices to ancestors,
2. pouring libations; and
3. giving the dead decent burials
4. providing basic needs to their children
5. bringing up children to be morally upright individuals. Further to this, the African traditional family is responsible for the upbringing, caring, and protection of its children.

The African traditional family is expected to participate in communal activities.



Work in the family was divided according to age, gender and social status.

Each family member worked for its basic needs as well as the welfare of the community

The African family had well-stated and practiced values There were

1. respect for family members
2. providing responsible parenthood,
3. educating children in all aspects of life.

Christian understanding of family

A family is a divine institution set by God from the beginning thus it is sacred.

A Christian family is founded on monogamous marriages.

In a Christian family children are not a must although they are considered as gift and blessing from God.

Each family should be made up of one man and woman to avoid cases of immorality

Family member should solve their disputes peacefully.

Husband and wife should be governed by love, submission and mutual obedience to each other.

E Christian family should enhance spiritual growth for its members.

Though the husband is the head of a Christian family, he should treat his wife with honour because both are equal before God.

Qualities that make a happy family are kindness, love, forgiveness, humility and gentleness.

Parents should be responsible to their children by

- ✓ Not discouraging their children or provoking them/
- ✓ Discipline children in order there can be peace and happiness.
- ✓ Train up children to grow morally upright
- ✓ Encourage children to go to church in order to grow spiritually

Children also have responsibilities in a Christian family including;

- ✓ Listen and obeying their parents instructions
- ✓ Should seek for guidance and counselling from their parents if need be



- ✓ Should honour and respect their parents
- ✓ They should not curse, scorn or mock their parents

Responsible parenthood

A responsible parent is one who brings up children morally upright and provides the children with basic needs such as food. Shelter, clothing, education, healthcare among other needs.

There are different parenting styles such as;

- a) Dictatorship /authoritative The parents are the final authority, imposes decisions
- b) Permissive or liberal style Also referred to as Laissez faire the children do as they want
- c) Democratic style parents Discuss with their children on family issues. This is the best style.

A responsible parent is one who

1. Bring positive role model for their children
2. Understands their roles and responsibilities in providing physical need for the family
3. Educating children in all aspects of life both formal and informal
4. Teaching them on religious matters and on how to grow in the Christian faith
5. Helping children to understand their physical, emotional and psychological changes they are going through as they are growing up
6. Contribute to their intellectual fulfilment by providing opportunities for them e.g. games music and other talents
7. Teaching moral and right behaviour to their children
8. Teaching children social skills on how to relate positively with other members of the society

Problems related to family life today

Families are faced with numerous problems such as

1. Children abuse — sex assault, beating
2. Domestic violence — abusive language, frequent fights, emotional abuse
3. Diseases e.g. HIV / AIDS epilepsy, autism.
4. Children with special needs, blindness, Autism etc.
5. Separation, divorce
6. Childlessness
7. Single parent families — economic hardships
8. Misuse of family resources, economic crisis
9. Affluence — a lot of wealth
10. Unemployment, underemployment
11. Retrenchment — laying off of some employees in order to reduce the workforce
12. Mismanagement of family finances
13. Alcohol and drug abuse
14. The generation gap
15. Poor relations with in-laws



16. Cultural and religious differences

Traditional African approaches to problems related to family life today

Individuals were prepared for challenges of family life right from childhood

Adolescents, initiates were given family life education

People entered marriage knowing that it's a lifelong union

Rules were clear to govern marriage relations Polygamy helped reduce unfaithfulness

There were no single parent families. Members lived together reducing loneliness

Widows / widowers were encouraged to marry again

Traditional brew was taken in moderation

Christians approaches to problems related to family life today

Christian families are obliged to live according to Christian principles and values such as mutual respect, self-discipline, understanding, honesty, faithfulness, love and forgiveness

Premarital counselling is carried out

Church holds regular seminars and conferences on family life matters. Love and respect for each other. Christian wife to submit to husband who is head of the family. They are taught to take each other as complementary and equal partners.

Women are encouraged to form participate in church organizations e.g. mothers union, womens guild where they learn roles of being a wife, mother, and a woman.

Some churches offer advice to families on management of their families. They are encouraged to have investments.

Breadwinner is encouraged to write a written will

To improve the parent — child relationship churches offer guidance and counselling to the youth

Christian parents are advised to set positive role models to their children

Parents are encouraged to be open and promote effective communication with their children

Churches in case of serious family conflicts such as child abuse, domestic violence, advise legal action.

Churches organize youth seminars where they talk about drug abuse, premarital sex, negative peer pressure and media influence etc.

Relevant information is passed through books, pamphlets, magazines, media FM, TV etc.

Some churches welcome unwed mothers

Churches provide health services, guidance on HIV / AIDS

Some churches care for widows, orphans, widowers and the needy



CHAPTER 6

CHRISTIAN APPROACHES TO WORK

Definition of terms

Work

Use of energy, physical or mental, for the purpose of improving human life. It is any activity that requires expenditure of energy or application of skills e.g. studying, teaching, cooking, farming etc.

Vocation

Work can be described as a vocation, profession, trade, craft, career or a job.

Vocation is from a Latin word Vocare which means call

Christians believe that every individual has been called of God to various duties.

Vocation is work that requires special skills, special training or a unique call or a special mission in society.

Profession

Work that is characterized by a code of ethics, lengthy specialized training, advance knowledge and self—discipline. Professionals have their own set standards. The professionals determine entry requirements for new members and usually have machinery for dealing with errant members. E.g. Law, medicine, architecture etc.

A trade

Refers to an occupation, a way of making a living. Some trades require specialized training examples hairdressing



A craft

An occupation which requires manipulative skills or use of the hands e.g. woodcarving, pottery, weaving. A craft may be a trade depending on the nature of occupation.

A career

An occupation that one chooses to pursue in his/her life. Its the general way of earning a living.

Job

Refers to tasks performed, services rendered in return for payment of wages. Most jobs are temporary others casual and others permanent and pension able..

General reasons why people work

1. Its an essential element of life
2. God ordained work. Humans work for their food
3. Work contributes to the development of the community
4. Work is personal. It defines a person
5. People work to earn a living
6. People work for enjoyment, leisure
7. To assist and give to the needy
8. To get luxuries
9. People work to raise their standards of living
10. For self-satisfaction and fulfilment
11. For personal development
12. To keep a person occupied and not idle
13. To acquire wealth and status in the society
14. To socialize with other members of the society
15. To attain independence and not depend on someone else

Traditional African attitude to work

Work is essential to the wellbeing of the individual and survival of the community

Work ensured basic needs such as food, shelters etc. were provided.

In traditional African society work was divided according to the age, gender, and status e.g. chief, elder of the individual.



Everyone was a worker. Boys assisted in herding, fishing, girls assisted in cooking fetching firewood. Women cooked, took care of babies constructed houses (maasai) etc.

Works among the traditional African societies included pastoralist, farmers, livestock keeping,

fishing, bee keeping etc.

Work was a communal affair; people would work together and assist each other

Work was not for a wage (Money). The rewards of work-included food, communal unity, acquisition of moral values etc.

Hard work was emphasized, laziness was condemned

There were some specific works for specialization e.g. herbal medicine men, divination, prophecy, rain making, pottery etc.

Work involved giving prayers, offerings, and sacrifices to God

Through work, the basic needs of the individual, community were fulfilled

Through work potentials; talents and skills were explored, acquired and utilized.

Work had a religious dimension as well as a social dimension. It brought people together improving their relations

Secular attitudes to work

In the secular world work is based on the following assumptions

- ✓ Available opportunities for future development in a particular job
- ✓ The need to serve others especially the church and the needy
- ✓ Interests, strengths, talents, abilities
- ✓ Inclination or attraction to a certain kind of work
- ✓ Pressure from parents, peers etc.
- ✓ Payment/wages/salaries
- ✓ Educational qualifications/professionalism

Christian teaching on work

The Christian teaching on work is based mainly on the interpretation of the bible, the teachings of Jesus and the teachings of the apostles. Some of the teachings are: -



God himself instituted work. He created the heavens and the earth and all in it. Since God worked man should work. (Gen. 2:1)

Gods work of creation is good (Gen. 1:31) Christians should endeavour to produce good works

Work is a duty, an obligation, a command Christians are responsible for Gods creation (Gen.2: 15). They are to protect it — animals, birds, plants, marine life are all under the care of man.

Human beings should work to acquire their basic needs (Genesis. 1:29 — 30, 3:19) God blesses the work of our hands

Human beings are co — creators with God (Gen.1: 28) God continue to create through human beings. Human beings glorify God through their work.

God reveals himself through his work of creation. God had a purpose for his creation. He is orderly, source of life, Almighty etc.

Work is a co — operative undertaking. Eve was created to be Adams helper (Gen. 2:20) Christians should co — operate in their undertakings

Hard work is praised and laziness is looked down upon. (Proverbs 31:27). Christians should work for their daily needs and not become a burden to others.

Work should be accompanied with rest (Gen.2: 2) God rested on the 7th day from all his work.

God commanded the Israelites to rest on the 7th day.

People should enjoy what they have worked for (Ecc.3: 22)

Work should be done for the glory of God and for the good of the society.

people should work honestly not steal but work to earn an honest living (Eph.4: 28)

Those who do not work should not eat

They should always work since God is always at a work (John 15:17)

Roles of professional ethos, ethics and codes in the society

Definitions

Professional ethics

Principles of behaviour / conduct that guide members of a particular profession.
What workers are allowed to do and not to do.

Professional ethos

The group identity of members of a profession, their unique custom or character e.g. what identifies doctors, lawyers etc.



Profession codes or code of ethics

Collection of laws arranged systematically according to major concerns and core functions of the profession

Roles

1. To regulate the behaviour of professional (workers)
2. Enables professionals to understand their role Ensures professionals provide quality of services to their clients
3. To encourage respect among professionals
4. Give guidance on how professionals should relate to one another
5. They safe guard professionals against being compromised / misused
6. They determine expected level of performance
7. They serve as a measure of competence
8. Act as a measure of quality service
9. They protect the professionals
10. They provide a reference point for disciplining (used to discipline the errant professional)
11. They inspire respect and high esteem for professionals
12. Through professional codes, ethics, ethos, professional earn public trust

Virtues related to work

A virtue is a good human habit. Its a moral principle, moral quality or goodness of character and behaviour.

Examples of virtues elated to work

- (I) Diligence — hardworking
- (ii) Honesty, integrity — ability to be relied upon (Integrity) Honest is being truthful.
- (iii) Faithfulness — being trustworthy and loyal
- (iv) Responsibility — ability to make decisions and take action independently. Being mindful of other peoples welfare
- (v) Tolerance — ability to bear with others or with difficult situations

Moral duties and responsibilities of employers and employees

Employers have several duties and responsibilities towards their employees. They are:



1. To organize and conduct business efficiently for the benefit of the institution, employer
2. To respect the employee, treat them with dignity
3. Pay a fair wage to the employee
4. Ensure good healthy and safe working conditions
5. Provide social welfare for the employees e.g. time off, leave days, time for recreation
6. Grant leave as required by law or the terms of contract
7. Take care of the welfare of the employees give medical cover, pension scheme etc.
8. To motivate their employees
9. To reward employees
10. Compensate employees made redundant

Rights of the employer

1. Employers have a right to/are entitled to
2. Get profits from their businesses
3. Carry out their businesses without unfair taxation
4. Form association with other employers
5. Obtain and conduct business
6. Hire, dismiss employees in accordance with the requirements of their firms and contract
7. demand a fair days work
8. Conduct business without subjection to unfair conditions and competitions

Moral duties of the employees

1. Carry out their duties to the best of their ability without supervision
2. Respect and protect the property of the employer
3. Encourage peaceful solutions to any problems encountered in their work place
4. To work diligently for self — fulfilment and development
5. To respect their employer and fellow employees
6. Observe terms of contract with employer
7. Be loyal, honest, respect to the employer



Rights of the employees

1. To receive fair wages
2. To have a reasonable work load Have reasonable hours of work
3. Have safety and protection at work Right to join a labour union
4. Right to further individual training and development education
5. Rights to retirement, terminal benefits Rights to a fair opportunity for provision A right to time for rest
6. Right to Favourable working conditions

Christians approaches to issues related to employment

Wages

A wage is payments for work done. Payment is in modern times done according to hours, weeks or days that one works.

Christian teachings on wages

Human beings have the right to work for a decent living (Matt.20:1 — 16) They should be paid for their work.

Workers should be paid wages to the amount and value of their work (1 Timothy 5:18)

Wages should be paid as agreed upon (Mathew 20:13)

Employers should not take advantage of the poverty of the employee (Deuteronomy 24:14 — 15)

Human beings should not be enslaved to work (Ex.5:22 — 23)

Employers who degrade their workers in wages are condemned (Deut.24:14 — 15, Jer.22:13)

Oppression is condemned (Amos 5:18, 8:4)

Workers wages should never be withheld (James 5:4)

Industrial action

Also commonly called Strike this is an effort by workers to stop work in protest by boycott go-slow sit — ins or refuse to work.

There has been increase of industrial action in the recent past in most countries of the world

Reasons for industrial actions

1. Due to increased awareness of workers rights



2. Exposure to global trends through the media
3. Formation of trade unions that fight for the rights of workers
4. Due to poor working conditions
5. Underpaying workers
6. Threatening workers with unjustified dismissals
7. Suspending the workers / interdiction — unjustly
8. A hostile working environment

Results of workers strikes (industrial / action

1. Pay cuts
2. Demotions
3. Loss of jobs
4. Employers suffer losses
5. Inflation
6. Injuries even death when confronted by police
7. Victimization of some individuals
8. Bitterness among the workers and employers

Christian approaches towards strikes

Christians recommend a peaceful co — existence between workers and employers

There should be fairness, justice, love among workers, employees

There should be an open communication channel across the ranks from top to bottom

Employees should not destroy property

Working conditions should be better and improved

Employees to be human when dealing with employees

Child labour

A child is a person below 18 years. A child does not have an identity card, does not vote (in Kenya).

According to International Labour Organization the minimum employment age is 14 years.



Child labour is engaging a person below the age of 14 years in wage / paid employment.

Reasons why children are employed

1. To provide cheap labour
2. They cannot fight for proper terms
3. They are easily hired and fire

Disadvantages of child labour

Children are not yet mentally and physically prepared to do adult jobs. This leads to

1. Exploitation of children
2. Children paid less, taken advantage of
3. It inhibits the growth of a child and denies them a chance to enjoy their childhood
4. It deprives them of their right to basic education
5. It exposes children to hazards (dangers) from machines, chemicals
6. Heavy workload deprives children of social educational, moral, psychological, rights

Children are employed in plantations — coffee, tea domestic services — homes tourism sector industries children are trafficked and employed as commercial sex workers

Causes of child labour/reasons why children work

1. Lack of money / poverty
2. Death of parents
3. Dropping out of school due to pregnancy, indiscipline, (truancy)
4. Lack of good role models
5. Influence of cultural values
6. Children being lured by employers
7. Greed for material benefits
8. Being homeless ending up as a street child

Position of church in dealing with child labour

The church condemns it

It has put up homes for poor children (orphanages)

It provides guidance, counselling to both parents and children



Children are blessing from God hence should be loved and cared for

Parents have the responsibilities to protect their children from harm.

Unemployment

When people are capable and willing to work but are unable to find a viable income or occupation it is referred to as unemployment.

Causes of unemployment

1. Preference for prestigious white collar jobs (Office jobs, non — manual jobs)
2. Corruption — tribalism, nepotism, bribery denying jobs to the qualified persons
3. Unequal distribution of wealth
4. Inadequate resources for self — employment (lack of capital, skills)
5. Limited job opportunities — probably due to high population growth
6. Few international investors in Kenya, probably due to high crime rate, insecurity

Response of Christians to issues of unemployment

They encourage self — employment in cases of unemployment

They have set up vocational training, polytechnics to train people towards jobs that are for self —employment

Christians condemn idleness

Self-employment

Self-employment is an economic activity initiated, controlled by an individual. It is an occupation in which a person initiates a personal enterprise and manages it with the help of others. Examples Small businesses enterprises, Jua kali sector, music industry

Problems/challenges of self-employment

Some lack sufficient capital to start a business and keep it running

Lack of necessary skills to run the business

High taxation leading to some business closing down

Small scale traders face undue competition from larger firms



CHAPTER 7

CHRISTIANS APPROACHES TO LEISURE

Definition of leisure

This is the time when one is free from work or other duties. Time at ones own disposal, which can be utilized in a productive manner depending on ones interests and abilities.

Leisure provides mental, physical relaxation, spiritual, emotional relaxation and enrichment

Forms of leisure

1. Passive leisure involves use of mental energy
2. Active leisure there is use of physical energy

Examples of activities of passive leisure are

- ✓ Watching television
- ✓ Reading story books
- ✓ Playing video games
- ✓ Chatting with friends



Examples of activities of active leisure are

- ✓ Jogging
- ✓ Mountain climbing
- ✓ Gardening
- ✓ Dancing
- ✓ Tree planting
- ✓ Playing football

Leisure is used for

- ✓ Enjoyment
- ✓ Entertainment — song, dance, watching movies etc.
- ✓ Relaxation — exercises
- ✓ Socialization — sharing, education
- ✓ Religious engagement — wedding ceremonies, visiting the sick, worship

Active leisure enables a person to

- ✓ Develop his/her body
- ✓ Build stamina
- ✓ Strengthen relationships etc.

Some leisure activities are dangerous e.g. boxing, motor racing while others are expensive e.g. golf.

Other leisure activities are addictive while others are unproductive.

Leisure activities should be planned for

Leisure activities can also be economic, income generating activities.

Traditional African understanding of leisure

In traditional African society leisure permeates all aspects of life.

Leisure activities accompany work. Leisure and work were entertainment.

Work was accompanied by singing, reciting stories sharing past events.

Examples of leisure activities in traditional African society include wrestling running playing ajua mock fighting swimming spear throwing poetry music and dance etc.

Other leisure activities that were communal e.g. Bull fighting tongue — twister poetry recitation telling of myths legends dancing brain teasers riddles etc.



Work in African society included fishing, tilling the land, herding, hunting, harvesting

Most leisure activities in traditional African society were active form of leisure,

Communal, not individualistic and not for monetary gains

All forms of leisure had an educational value. Folk stories had a moral value. People were taught not to be selfish, greedy jealousy etc. Myths and legends tell of the origin of the community and its history of important people as well as history of the community.

In African traditional society, leisure led to acquisition of values or virtues such as cooperation, sharing, solidarity, love, bravery, empathy, endurance, tolerance etc.

Most activities were linked to the worship of God and, veneration of the ancestors

Leisure activities were organized along gender and age group season (E.g. harvest — dancing, singing); wet rainy seasons — boat swimming

Rites of passage e.g. initiation, marriage, birth and naming provided leisure activities

Leisure activities were planned for

Christian teaching on leisure

Christians teach that Work and leisure are of divine origin. God rested on the 7th day after working

Leisure is a gift from God leisure should be put to good use. It should not be wasted

Leisure provides us with the opportunity to worship God. Leisure should be used to serve God.

Christians associate leisure with personal growth and fellowship

Jesus recognized the need for rest by withdrawing his disciples from their active ministry. It is good to have time alone for reflection, rest, visit friend etc.

Leisure should be used to seek God and help others e.g. Jesus prayed, helped the needy, restored people's health.

Ways Christians use their leisure time — activities

1. Worshipping God
2. Visiting the sick
3. Caring for the needy
4. Resting
5. Watching television
6. Chatting with family members



7. Retreat — time spend away with a group of people to be alone with God
8. Visiting friends, relatives
9. Reading the bible
10. Praying etc.

Importance of leisure

Leisure is necessary. Its important in various ways

1. It is a good time to assess the work we have done (Reflection time)
2. It brings people together leading to self — growth and fulfilment
3. Leisure helps individuals to discover their hidden talents
4. Leisure relaxes the mind — a change of activity, relieves the mind
5. Leisure refreshes the body — restores lost energy
6. Leisure enables Christians to offer charity to those in need
7. Leisure provides time for worship and spiritual renewal
8. Leisure gives one time to rest
9. Its time for recreation
10. Give one time to attend social occasions
11. Allows people to travel and visit friends and relatives
12. Leisure can be used to enhance and acquire new skills and knowledge
13. Its a time to develop and discover ones talents

Uses of leisure — proper of leisure

Leisure can be used for

1. Religious experience
2. A time for rest
3. Leisure is used to provide us with time to help others
4. Leisure can be used to spread the word of God
5. Development of talents
6. Its an opportunity for individual growth
7. Leisure strengthens social relationships



8. Leisure can be used for reflection on ones decision etc. leisure activities reveal who we are.
9. Leisure can be used for educative and economic purposes
10. Proper use of leisure is when leisure time is spent doing activities that add value to us.

Misuse of leisure today

Leisure time can be misused through various activities e.g.

1. Spending too much time in passive activities e.g. pornography watching, watching films that are violent
2. Spending leisure time in idle talk — gossip-leading to conflicts
3. Spending time in gambling, casinos making bets on horses playing Ajua games etc.
4. Alcohol and drug taking — when a person over drinks alcohol, spends time drinking
5. Leisure can also be misused by engaging in dangerous activities.
6. Night dancing, disco dancing has become a common form of leisure worldwide.

Drug abuse and its effects - alcohol, soft and hard drugs

A drug is any substance which when taken may alter or cause changes in the normal functioning of the body.

Drug abuse

Improper use of drugs. Using a drug for another purpose than what it is intended for

Drug use

Drugs are taken in various forms liquids lotions ointment powder

Drugs are classified as legal and illegal

Ways of administering drugs are taken /administered in various ways injecting inhaling / smoking chewing swallowing drinking sniffing / snuffing

Categories of drugs Medicinal, Soft drugs, Hard / narcotic drugs



Types of drugs

1. Preventive drugs e.g. drugs to prevent polio, cholera, yellow fever
2. Curative drugs — drugs that cure diseases
3. Sedatives, palliatives — drugs that alleviate pain, put patients to sleep e.g. drugs for diabetes, heart diseases, asthma, painkillers
4. Tranquillizers — drugs that relieve tension induce sleep e.g. piriton, valium
5. Stimulants — drugs used to increase physiological activity of a particular organ. They arouse the activity of the central nervous system / senses.
6. Volatile drugs — these drugs intoxicate the user, they are derived from petroleum products paint thinners dry cleaning fluids glue etc. stimulants and volatile drugs classified as soft drugs.
7. Hard drugs or narcotic drugs These are highly addictive drugs. The body forms dependence on these drugs.

These drugs affect the mind causing drowsiness; sleep, stupor and they are the most commonly abused drugs. Examples are

Cocaine

From coca leaves

A very expensive drug

Side effects

- ✓ Its highly addictive
- ✓ Causes mental problems
- ✓ Can lead to death on overdose
- ✓ Can cause confusion, Convulsions, circulatory collapse and rapid heart beat

Bhang / Marijuana

A plant of Indian hemp

Also called marijuana, Hashish, Cannabis, Sativa depending on which part of the plant is taken i.e. leaves, stem, or roots.

Side effects

Users become aggressive excited or high

Bhang changes perception of space, time and reality

It causes drowsiness and irresponsible behaviour



Its side effects cause people to be engaged in criminal activities e.g. robbery

Morphine

- ✓ Its used to suppress pain clinically
- ✓ Its addictive
- ✓ Its derived from cocaine
- ✓ Used as local aesthetic

Heroin

Its pain relieving

Highly addictive

Powder heated in foil paper, vapour forms hence smoked referred to as” chasing the dragon”

Also called brown sugar

Its injected and inhaled

An overdose can lead to death

Its expensive

It causes respiratory problems

Its depressive

Withdrawal symptoms when heroine is not available are nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea and severe anxiety

Soft drugs

Includes Cigarette Alcohol Miraa / khat

Cigarette

Made from tobacco

Cigarettes contain

- a) Nicotine — a highly addictive substance.
- b) Carbon monoxide, which damages arteries heart and lungs
- c) Tar — black substance which promotes cancer of the throat, heart and lungs

Cigarettes are legal drugs in Kenya.

Side effects



- ✓ Pregnant women may miscarry or terminate the pregnancy if they smoke.
- ✓ Leads to chest respiratory diseases poor blood circulation
- ✓ Leads to destructive fires due to carelessness

Miraa / khat

Plants / legally in Kenyan, and other parts of the world. They are chewed

Side effects

- ✓ Causes temporary excitement
- ✓ Makes one loose appetite for food and sex
- ✓ The juice in miraa causes temporary excitement in the user when ingested
- ✓ Miraa makes the user to be irritable

Alcohol

Alcohol is a drug made through fermentation

Its a drink used in social ceremonial occasions

Its in form of beer wines, traditional brew (e.g. busaa, muratina, mnazi) and spirits e.g. whisks, brandy, gin, changaa

Alcohol is prepared by fermentation or distillation — heating to a certain degree.

In African traditional society, alcohol was fermented and used for

Medicinal value

- ✓ Entertainment
- ✓ Marriage celebrations
- ✓ Beer parties given to visitors

Excessive drinking was discouraged

Drunk people were scorned or scolded

Young people were not allowed to drink alcohol

When alcohol is taken excessively it is abused

Alcohol abuse

Alcohol can lead to body dependence or addiction

Consequences of abusing alcohol are such as

(I) Squandering family resources



- (ii) Health deterioration
- (iii) Lack of concentration leading to poor quality of work
- (iv) Family break-ups due to frustrations
- (v) Deformed foetus if a mother abuses alcohol when pregnant
- vi) Alcohol destroys brain cells
- (vii) It leads to unruly behaviour such as fights, violence
- (viii) One is vulnerable to risky behaviour —vulnerable to sexual infections such as HIV / AIDS
- (ix) Can make a person cause accidents if driving under the influence of alcohol

Reasons why people abuse alcohol and drugs

- (i) Frustration due to unemployment, inability to perform well and meet set standards
- (ii) Idleness — when idle some turn to alcohol and drug use
- (iii) Addiction
- (iv) Boredom
- (v) Bad examples from adults
- (vi) Availability of drugs in the Kenyan market
- (vii) Negative peer pressure
- (viii) Experimentation then addiction
- (ix) Media influence
- (x) Societal permissiveness
- (xi) Urbanization
- (xii) Pressure of work
- (xiii) Financial stress
- (xiv) Globalization — foreign world influences

Effects of drug abuse

Drug abuse poses danger to the health of a person, affects family, society in general.
Effects of drug abuse are



1. Psychological problems — drugs are addictive. The body becomes dependant on them. It cannot perform without the drugs. It leads to depression, irritability, aggressiveness, paranoia, one becoming afraid to face reality etc.
2. Crime — robbery, theft, people abusing drugs will rob, steal so as to get money to buy the drugs. Drugs have led to students setting schools on fire, killing their fellow students
3. Illusion — users do not face reality
4. Health problems — one is prone to diseases because of frequent use of drugs. Drugs weakens the bodys system e.g. alcohol leads to liver Cirrhosis, stomach ulcers. One is susceptible / prone to HIV / AIDS infection STIs lung cancer, still birth etc.
5. Economic problems Drugs are expensive. Abuse leads to depletion of family resources leading to poverty
6. Loss of job and income
7. Social problem Abuse of drugs leads to family conflicts, leading to separation, divorce, family quarrels fights and even murder (domestic violence)
8. Accidents
9. Frustrations
10. Poor performance in school work
11. Death People die out of drug abuse. An over dose of heroin, cocaine kills. Alcohol can lead to a blackout, this affects the brain

Remedies to drug abuse

Law enforcement

Through bodies such as UNDCP United Nations International Drug Control Programme Anti-Narcotics Police Units, NACADA National Agency for the Campaign Against Drug Abuse so as to control abuse of Narcotics and other drugs.

Education

People to be educated on the effects of drugs. The curriculum from primary to secondary to include topics on drug abuse.

Guidance and counselling

Religious teachings — all religious condemn the abuse of drugs

Family values to be promoted.

Parents should set good examples to their children

Every individual to cultivate individual values. Respect their body and take care of their bodies



Rehabilitation of drug users / abusers

Christian criteria for evaluating the use of leisure

Criteria — criterion — a principle or standard for judging something.

- ✓ Christians, should engage in leisure activities which promote their respect and dignity they should socialize with people who are morally upright (bad company corrupts good morals)
- ✓ God ordains leisure hence it should serve Gods purpose.
- ✓ Leisure should come after work
- ✓ Leisure should be used for the good of others. The activities that are harmful to others should be avoided
- ✓ Activities chosen should enrich their knowledge of God
- ✓ Activities should provide service to others
- ✓ Leisure doesnt mean laziness
- ✓ A Christian should not engage in a harmful activity to self but those that promote respect and dignity
- ✓ Christians to avoid activities that lead to sin or to addiction
- ✓ They should perform an activity which develop their physical emotional social and spiritual well being
- ✓ Leisure should be enjoyed with moderation
- ✓ Activities for leisure should be moral, within the laws of God and pleasing to good.

CHAPTER 8

CHRISTIANS APPROACHES TO WEALTH, MONEY AND POVERTY

Definition of the concepts wealth, money and poverty



a) Wealth

Accumulation of materials owned by an individual, family or a group of people. Wealth is property that has economic value e.g. land, animals, money, valuable possessions such as jewellery, commercial and residential buildings etc.

Ways of acquiring wealth

1. Inheritance
2. Business
3. Commercial farming
4. Salaried Jobs
5. Investment of money in financial institution
6. Provision of commercial services

b) Money

Its the medium of exchange that functions as a legal tender. It is something that is generally accepted as a medium of exchange, a means of payment. It is usually in form of coins or notes. Good monetary media (money) has certain qualities.

Qualities of money

It should be acceptable

It should be fairly stable

Easy to divide into small units

Easy to carry

Should be relatively scarce

It should be durable

Its value should be maintained through proper control of its circulations

Money is a measure of wealth. What it can purchase is the value. Money is used to buy services, goods, pay debts etc.

Examples of currencies in the world are Ksh. (Kenya), Rand (South Africa) US & Dollar, Pound (Britain) Euro (Europe), Yen (Japan) Etc

c) Poverty

State of being without adequate basic necessities of life e.g. food, shelter, clothing

Its a state of helplessness. It is characterized by poor health, hunger, and lack of education facilities, uncared for environment.



Causes of poverty

- a. Adverse climatic conditions (Geographical factors)
- b. Poor family background (historical and social factors)
- c. Political stability leading to civil wars
- d. Poor governance
- e. Regional imbalance of natural resources
- f. Low level of technology
- g. Laziness
- h. Over dependence on foreign aid

The traditional African understanding of wealth and poverty

Wealth

In African traditional societies wealth was measured in terms of the amount of land, livestock, grains, wives, children possessed by an individual or the community.

Wealth was acquired in various ways.

- ✓ As a gift from God Most
- ✓ Inheritance
- ✓ Bride wealth
- ✓ Farming
- ✓ Exploitation of natural resources
- ✓ Trade
- ✓ Raids

People were encouraged to work hard to acquire wealthy honestly

Wealthy people were highly regarded and were considered for leadership position

Wealth was incomplete without a family

Poverty

Poverty was viewed as punishment or curse for wrongdoing.

Other causes of poverty according to African Traditional Society were: -

- ✓ Laziness



- ✓ Lack of inheritance
- ✓ Raids by other communities
- ✓ Famine
- ✓ Natural calamities
- ✓ Sickness — rendering the individual weak to acquire wealth

In acquiring wealth, principles such as value for human life, mutual responsibility, and sharing, communal ownership were emphasized.

Places that were communal include grazing land, rivers, and watering places

Laziness was ridiculed through songs, riddles and proverbs.

Impacts of the introduction of money economy in traditional African society

Introduction

Money was introduced to Africa by the Europeans Before colonial period, Africans practiced barter trade — actual goods exchanged with other goods e.g. animals would be exchanged with food grains, millet, sorghum, cowpeas, children exchanged for food during famine.

Trade merchants from Asia had introduced into Africa forms of currency such as the cowrie shells, gold and the Indian rupees. Europeans introduced currency still used today

- ✓ Economy: — careful management of resources, finances, income and expenditure of a family, a business enterprise, community or a country. The economy of a country is to be well managed if it has the ability to meet the social economic needs of her members.
- ✓ Economic development Its measured by the health of its economy in the provision of health, education, housing, sanitation, employment, and longevity of life, decrease of material and child mortality.

Money economy: — Use of money as a means of exchange in economic activities e.g. banking, investment, insurance, payment of goods and services.

Reasons for money introduction

- 1) Colonization brought a lot of changes such as unoccupied land declared Crown land for colonialists.
- 2) Tax introduction



Africans were supposed to pay taxes to the government. Taxes were paid in form of money.

3) Introduction of formal education

School fees was introduced. Fees were paid in form of money.

4) Introduction of modern medical services

People paid medical services using money.

6) Emergence of new lifestyles

Converts to Christianity were emphasized on to have materials, hence had to work to improve their living standards. They built houses, took their children to schools practiced modern family techniques hence had to use money.

Impact of the introduction of money economy in traditional African society

Introduction of wage — labour

Break up of family ties as people migrated from rural to urban areas in search of employment

African land taken by the colonialists, reducing people to squatters hence need to work

There was creation of a gap between people — the rich and the poor

Emergence of vices e.g. corruption, bribery, prostitution, robbery

Deterioration of cherished African values e.g. bride wealth has become commercialized, customs lost etc.

Loss of African human dignity. Africans had to pay taxes to the colonial government. They were forced to work in European worked under dehumanizing conditions

Production of traditional food crops declined replaced by cash crops.

Individual ownership of land was emphasized. Land could be sold at will

There was increase of rural — urban migration leaving the rural people less educated.

Exploitation of the poor by the rich — poor wages, overcharging prices on foods.

Destruction of the natural environment to create room for building projects, urban centres

The cost of living increased. Almost everything is acquired by money.

The Christian teaching on wealth, money, poverty



Teaching on wealth

Wealth is a blessing from God

Those who obey Gods teachings of the prophets are promised blessings by God Deut 28:1 — 4

Wealth has duties associated with it e.g. 10% tithe, alms to the poor, and an aspect of stewardship.

Wealth should be used wisely. People are not owners of their property but are stewards. Should share with the poor, needy.

Wealth is not permanent e.g. parable of the rich fool. When people die, they take nothing with them. Naked into the world, naked out of the world. Job. 1:21

Wealth can create a false sense of independence feeling of self-reliance no need for God

Wealth should be obtained justly no happiness for a person who gets riches in the wrong way.

Wrong attitude to wealth can lead to idolatry and other dangers. Matt. 19: 23 — 24 danger of materialism — making riches their God, the love of money is the root of all evil (1 timothy 6:10)

It is wrong to discriminate against others on the basis of material possessions. Jesus associated with the rich, the poor, the sick etc.

Seek spiritual wealth, which is permanent and more fulfilling than material wealth, which is transitory — temporal. Matt 6:19 — 20)

Acknowledge God as the source of ones riches

Use wealth to help the needy

Wealth is an instrument to enable us live decently.

Obsession with money and wealth leads to sin

Church leaders should avoid greed for wealth (1 Timothy 3:3)

God will judge rich exploiters.

Christian teaching on poverty

Christian teachings discourage irresponsible behaviour and habits e.g. laziness, idleness and negligence. Some people became poor because of such.

Some people become poor because of misfortunes

Others are poor because of judgment due to disobedience to God



God cares for the poor

Those with more should share with the poor

People should work to alleviate poverty in the society

Jesus helped the poor so should we should do the same

Christian approaches/response to issues related to wealth and money.

Affluence

having a lot of material possessions and a luxurious standard of living. Poverty is a state of lack of the basic necessities.

Illegal means of acquiring wealth include fraud, grabbing public land, selling narcotic drugs etc.

Factors that have contributed to poverty

1. Political instability
2. Lack of formal education
3. Laziness
4. Negative attitude towards work — choosing jobs
5. Historical factors — colonization lack of land
6. Exporting unprocessed agricultural products cheaply then sold back expensively.

Fair distribution of wealth / resources

Christians to promote the value of justice, fairness, social responsibility. How? By having anti — corruption crusades, be role models, teach or impart skills, advocate for cancellation of foreign debts, taxation to all etc.

- ✓ Fair salaries
- ✓ Promotion of affordable and decent housing
- ✓ Favourable terms of loans
- ✓ Encourage Juu Kali artisans

Christians to demand transformation of society through implementation of just economic policies that can ensure fair distribution of wealth.



Encourage foreign investors through good infrastructure, incentives e.g. shorter process to register business, security.

Christian to encourage investments by churches and inculcate in people the values of hard work, proper time management free education free health care for the poor or needy.

Fair distribution of wealth / resources refers to jobs, infrastructure, hospitals, water, agricultural products etc.

Bribery and corruption

Bribery and corruption are related terms.

Corruption: — practice of giving a bribe in the form of money, goods or privileges in return for a service.

Bribery: — act of giving money, material goods or services to someone to influence the recipient to give underserved favour.

It is aimed at influencing a decision to favour. Bribery is a form of corruption.

Corruption is some kind of moral degeneration. A practice whereby someone uses his/her influence in an activity that is not morally acceptable.

Example of corruption include promotion by a senior for a favour, colluding to miss work, use of government vehicles to attend to personal matters.

Factors leading to bribery and corruption

1. Un-employment — one will bribe to secure employment
2. Greed for money — caused by peer pressure, poor moral values,
3. Fear — fear of being imprisoned
4. Ignorance — giving bribes in form of gifts
5. Disintegration of traditional African values
6. Lack of moral integrity — no Christian values, one having no spiritual basis
7. Frustration in the place of work
8. A perverted conscience

Consequences of corruption and bribery

1. Leads to injustice
2. Leads to poor services e.g. road construction



3. Poor infrastructure, poor public service delivery
4. Leads to undermining moral fabric of society — leading to social hopelessness and despair
5. Has led to lack of trust in public servants, and the government
6. Discontentment among people.
7. Degrades the personality of an individual
8. Can lead to imprisonment and lose of job

Christian attitude towards bribery and corruption

It is condemned as an evil practice (a social evil) Ex. 23:8

Bribes cause injustice proverbs 17:23

Seen as morally wrong as they negatively affect ones family

Jesus drove out merchants from the temple. They had started exploitation of the poor.

Condemned because it degrades the personality of an individual

Amos condemned taking and giving of bribes

Bribes blinds the eyes

In the parable of **J**ohn, the Baptist condemned soldiers from taking bribes

Corrupt judge and the widow, corruption is condemned

Christians are to live righteously and not give bribes or receive. They are the light of the world.

Money gained from corruption is not acceptable before



CHAPTER 9

CHRISTIAN APPROACHES TO LAW, ORDER AND JUSTICE

Definition of terms

Law

Established rules by an authority to regulate human behaviour in the community

Schools laws, religious laws, factory laws, hospital laws etc. laws differ from society to society. Laws are dynamic. Laws cover all aspects of life.

Order

Condition brought about by obedience to set rules or laws. Order leads to peaceful co — existence in the society. Where there is order, things are done systematically. The opposite of order is disorder.

Types of laws

1. Non — legal laws — no court action e.g. school rules
2. Customary traditional laws — based on culture, social traditions. They have to agree with state laws. They are respected by state.
3. Statutory laws / legal laws — laws made by local council or national government and citizens are expected to obey them.

Types of statutory laws

- a) Civil laws — made by parliament on issues such as taxes, labour, divorce etc.
- b) Criminal law — on crime / punishment
- c) Constitutional law — matters of state and governance



- d) Company law
- e) Religious laws e.g. Islamic law sharia

Justice

Treating others, the way they deserve in relation to the law. Its administration of rightful dealings in a fair manner according to their actions.

A just society follows rules and administers legal action to those who offend others or disobey rules. Justice means treating people the same way without discrimination.

Importance of law, order and justice

- 1) They are essential to preserve harmony and protect people
- 2) Laws guide people and ensure peoples rights are protected.
- 3) They protect peoples property and enable people to live in harmony
- 4) They protect the consumer from exploitation
- 5) They safeguard religious freedom
- 6) Laws control power of those in authority and promote political stability
- 7) Provides stability, encouraging economic growth
- 8) Helps to control discontentment among people
- 9) Helps implementation of taxes effectively
- 10) Provides / help in maintenance of security
- 11) Ensures human rights are upheld
- 12) Enables the government to protect its citizens from internal or external threats.
- 13) International law regulates relations between countries.

Rights and duties of citizens

Citizen — person who is a member of a state, kingdom, empire. A person who has full rights as a member of a country by birth, decent, registration, naturalization.

Rights — legal claims that one is entitled to from the government

Duty — ones responsibility to the government.

Rights

- 1) Right to life — to live securely



- 2) Right to education
- 3) Right to liberty / freedom
- 4) Right to protection of property
- 5) Right to own a family — right to marry and raise a family
- 6) Right to health
- 7) Freedom of movement
- 8) Right to freedom of association
- 9) Right to freedom of assembly
- 10) Freedom of religion
- 11) Right to own property
- 12) Right to equality — non discrimination
- 13) Protection of freedom of expression and speech (own opinions, ideas)

Children have rights e.g. Right to life, education, parental care, health, protection from exploitation, right to identity etc.

Duties of citizens (responsibilities)

- 1) Pay taxes to the government
- 2) Respect the flag and national anthem
- 3) Respect those in authority
- 4) Respect the laws of the land
- 5) Register as a voter and vote in national elections
- 6) Be responsible at work
- 7) Participate in national development
- 8) Promote peace and harmony in the society
- 9) Report errant members of the society to law enforcement agents
- 10) Protect the environment — clean, plant trees, avoid poaching etc.

Traditional African practices that promote law, order, justice

Punishment of offenders

People who committed offences such as stealing, murder, witchcraft were punished through death, curses, paying heavy fines etc. this promoted law, order, justice



Installation of rules, kings, chiefs, elders

They were installed to maintain law, order and to execute justice in their areas of jurisdiction

Administration of oaths

Administered by specialists and are used as a method of establishing and maintaining law and order

Making of covenants

Covenants were made if there was a conflict between two communities. They would promise to live in peace and harmony.

Observing of taboos and customary law

Taboos were prohibitions. Those who went against taboos were severely punished

The kinship system — defined how people related one to another

Rites of passage — ensured customs, laws were adhered to

Religious practices- such as praying, singing, sacrificing and giving of offerings had the effect of maintaining order.

Biblical teaching on law, order and justice

God initiated Law, order, and justice.

Gods creation is orderly. God desires order

Man was created with a conscience to know right from wrong sin has consequences or punishment. God does punish disobedience i.e. justice

God instituted the laws as part of his plan for salvation e.g. law of circumcision, Torah (10 commandments), circumcision of the heart, laws on what to eat etc.

Gods law governed kingship in Israel. National prosperity depended on a kings ruler ship.

Kings were to ensure law and order

In the New Testament John, the Baptist urged people to observe the law (social justice).

Jesus taught that the kingdom of God is based on law, order and justice. There should be fair treatment for all people

Jesus said that the Law of Moses was given to guide people

Christians should obey the law of the land and respect those in authority



The apostolic teachings stress the need for law, order and justice (I Cro.14: 33)

Christians should be orderly.

The birth of Jesus was orderly. His ministry was also orderly hence should Christians.

Causes of social disorder and their remedies

Social disorder is a state of confusion or lack of order in the society

Discrimination

Discrimination is unfair treatment. Discrimination is on basis of race tribe and sex/gender

People or a particular person is singled out and treated with disfavour or distaste. It is showing bias or prejudice.

Causes of discrimination

- a. Culture
- b. Prejudice — bias original/stereotypes
- c. Ignorance e.g. on HIV /AIDS
- d. Social status — ones position in a society

Inequitable distribution of wealth and resources

This is when riches of family, community, and nation are not fairly shared out due to Selfishness or poor planning. Some areas are marginalized.

Racism

Unfair treatment of people because of their race

Tribalism

Discrimination on basis of ethnic group

Crime

An offence against state, normally settled in court. Its antisocial behaviour causing disorder.

Causes of crime (Why people commit crime)

1. Poverty
2. Public mistrust for law enforces
3. Lack of parental guidance



4. Wide gap between the rich and the poor
5. Greed for power, money
6. Materialism
7. Drug and substance abuse

Sexism

Discrimination against people because of gender

Women are discriminated in areas such as jobs, no promotion for women, oppression of women at home, cultural values demeaning the status of women, wife beating / men beating, female genital mutilation (FGM) early children marriages etc.

Remedies to social disorder

- ✓ Rehabilitation for drugs users / abusers
- ✓ Punishment for offenders of crime Forms of punishment imprisonment payment of fines
- ✓ Equitable distribution of national resources Develop marginalized areas create jobs
- ✓ Campaign against drug abuse
- ✓ The public to use hot lines to report crime to police
- ✓ Preach against racism, tribalism, and preach equality, freedom and interaction
- ✓ People to be sensitized to appreciate and respect different ethnic groups
- ✓ Promote national unity through education /cultural programmes
- ✓ Creation of more national schools so as to have students from all backgrounds
- ✓ Encourage domestic tourism
- ✓ Enlighten women on their rights
- ✓ Employment on merit
- ✓ Rich countries to share wealth with the poor

Role of Christians in transforming the social, economic, political life of the society

Transformation is to completely change the attitude, character, and well-being of the society



Christian participation in the social life

Christians are involved in the preaching of the gospel in many places in the country.
They use print and electronic media to spread the gospel.

Christians have shown concern for the destitute and victims of violence in the society by building homes for them and providing them with food and clothing.

Christians run schools, vocational institutions and universities providing educational services

Christians offer medical services to the society

They speak openly against sexual immorality, murder, bribery, corruption, abortion etc.

They show compassion to those in need the poor, HIV / AIDS orphans, widows, widowers, aged etc.

They offer guidance and counselling to dysfunctional families (the pastors, those trained to do counselling — almost all pastors get a training in guidance and counselling)

Christians participation in the political life

Christians participate in the political life by advocating for fair distribution of wealth

They offer prayers for government, political leaders

They exercise their right by voting

They also participating in the political life by standing up for elections (Vying for elections)

Christian participation in economic life

Christians participate in economic life by paying taxes to the government

By contributing in collection of funds for construction of churches, schools, hospitals

They invest in business that promotes their own development as well as the development of the country.

They provide financial resources in order to assist others to start economic activities or self-employment

They discourage business practices such as using faulty scales, hiking of prices cheating in business etc. and encourage proper acquisition of wealth

The church — state relationship

The government and the church interact at various levels and in different areas



Religious leaders give advice to the state

The church speaks against corruption, abortion, vices which the government is fighting

The church is the conscience of the state

Both educate the citizens on the constitution and their rights

The church preaches peace, love, unity, order

The state needs support of the church in mobilizing citizens to adopt government policies

Both are involved in rehabilitation of prisoners

The church builds schools and other institutions that supplement government institutions.

The church is involved in formulation of educational curriculum.

However, the church differs with government on various issues such as

- Use of condoms (Some churches opposed to this)
- Use of live bullets by the law enforces when curbing riots
- Fight on corruption a thorn to the church since state leaders are involved
- Issue of death penalty — church been fighting against death penalty to convicts

CHAPTER 10

CHRISTIAN APPROACHES TO SELECTED ISSUES RELATED TO MODERN SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND ENVIRONMENT

Definitions

Science

Subject field that deals with a systematic study of our surroundings and behaviour of materials in the universe



It is based on observation, experimentation and measurement.

Technology

Application of science to achieve desired objectives.

Environment

Our surroundings — both natural and human made i.e. Mountains, lakes, land, forests, animals, buildings, flowers etc.

Positive and negative effects of science and technology

Ways science and technology has improved human lives

- ✓ Improvement of crop production — a quality seeds, fertilizers leading to improved yields
- ✓ Better nutrition, health care, medical services
- ✓ Improvement of livestock production through artificial insemination
- ✓ It has led to development of efficient means of transport — land, air, seas
- ✓ Work has been made easier and enjoyable. There is use of machines, automation,
- ✓ Peoples lives have been spared, saved e.g. through life saving machines (ICU), incubators
- ✓ Business transactions are being done through the internet
- ✓ Communication has been made easy — fax, email, short text messages on mobile phones etc.
- ✓ Research is ongoing for incurable diseases i.e. HIV / AIDS, cancer
- ✓ There is better management of environment
- ✓ Technology has made the world a global village
- ✓ Through family planning methods, its easier to control population growth
- ✓ Theres a better security system through use of scanners, alarms, electrified fences etc.
- ✓ Improvement of learning through e—learning
- ✓ Theres easier movement from one country to another

Negative effects of science and technology

- ✓ People use medicine to commit suicide



- ✓ Increase of crime, fraud and death through modern means of communication
- ✓ Destruction of family relationships
- ✓ Breakdown of community names, values morals, breakdown of families
- ✓ Terrorism
- ✓ Greed for money / materialism
- ✓ Unemployment — replacement of personnel by machines
- ✓ Health hazards such as accidents in factories
- ✓ Pollution, air poisoning

Christian view on issues related to science and technology.

Euthanasia

Its a Greek word, which means an easy and painless death. It is mercy killing ending a persons life so as to alleviate them from experiencing pain.

Its practiced with the sick persons knowledge

It is involuntary when its practiced against or without the sick persons consent

Its done by injecting an overdose of sleeping pills to the sick person switching off life support machine exposing the person with chronic pneumonia to very cold air.

Christians view on Euthanasia

Christians are opposed to euthanasia for several reasons such as

- ✓ Life is sacred; a gift from God and only God can take away human life
- ✓ Suffering is part of human life
- ✓ Euthanasia is against medical ethos, which demands preservation of human life.
- ✓ Jesus has power over sickness and through his name all sickness are healed
- ✓ Euthanasia discourages medical research on vaccines that may cure various diseases.
- ✓ Euthanasia discourages patients and makes them to lose hope in life.

Blood transfusion

Its the process of injecting a persons blood into another person through his/her veins.
The giver is a donor the receiver is a recipient.



Blood has to be screened for any diseases, and then kept in blood bank after determining the blood group. The transfusion should be in a hygienic way. The equipment used should be sterilized

Donors should not be below 16 years or above 65 years

Reasons for blood transfusion

1. When a person is suffering from acute anaemia (little blood in the body) low blood level.
2. To restore blood lost during fatal accidents, wars, or childbirth
3. To maintain blood levels for patients undergoing major operations
4. To correct the low haemoglobin level of some patients

Alternatives to blood transfusion

- a) Volume expanders — increase fluid levels in the body
- b) Growth factors — intra operative / post-operative
- c) Blood salvage — save blood when on surgery is saved then transfused back to the patient

Christian view on blood transfusion

- ✓ Some Christians believe it is wrong to take blood from a healthy person and transfuse it to another person.
- ✓ Blood is life and life cannot be taken from one person to another
- ✓ Blood transfusion is essential as it saves life
- ✓ Blood transfusion can transmit dangerous diseases like HIV / AIDS and Hepatitis B
- ✓ God has given Christians the intelligence and capability to make the right decision

Organ transplant

This is the removal of a defective organ and replacing it with a healthy one. Body organs transplanted are kidneys, heart and eyes small intestines, pancreas.

The purpose is to replace the damaged organ of a recipient

Common transplants are the heart, kidney, eyes from living and the dead (heart) within a span of hours. Eyes can be transplanted from animals.



Christian view on organ transplant

- ✓ It saves life hence acceptable to some
- ✓ Its transferring human life from one person to another
- ✓ Its wrong to transplant from animals — view by some Christians
- ✓ Some support organ transplant by referring to the story of creation
- ✓ It is part of human beings continuing with the creation work of God.
- ✓ It is an expression of love and concern for those suffering as taught by Jesus Christ.

Genetic engineering

Its a scientific technique used by scientists to change the biological characteristics of living organisms by deliberately altering the structure of individual genes.

There are genetically modified foods, genetically engineered seeds, test tube babies, human clones, and genes of human insulin.

Human cloning

This is a form of genetic engineering. Its a creation of genetically identical copy of a human being, human cell.

Therapeutic cloning is when cells from an adult are used in creating medicine or for research

Reproduction cloning is the making of human beings

More than 90% of cloning has failed.

Animals cloned have died young, had cancers or arthritis.

Human cloning is illegal worldwide

Genetic cells are used to treat Alzheimer, heart attack, cancer

Test tube babies are different from human cloning.

Reasons for advocating human cloning

- ✓ Can clone people whose genetic composition is of a genius,
- ✓ Can be able to bring, revive back great extinct characteristics.
- ✓ Those who support it believes it can reduce immorality

Reasons against human cloning

- ✓ God is the sole creator. Cloning takes the place of God.
- ✓ It de—humanizes human beings purpose of human reproduction



- ✓ It destroys uniqueness of each individual (Cloning is an exact copy)
- ✓ It can be abused and used to create antisocial people (rapists, thieves)
- ✓ May create deformed people
- ✓ Its un-ethical, immoral experiment. Its destruction of the embryo hence abortion
- ✓ 95% of clones have failed (animal) most animals died
- ✓ Its illegal
- ✓ Cloned animals died of cancer, had arthritis, deformities and an early death
- ✓ Cloning may bring a destructive copy of humans

Advantages of genetic engineering

1. Implanting genes that are diseases free in people, plant and animals could prevent diseases.
2. Genetic crops yield more
3. Helps to determine the biological parent in case of dispute on babies (DNA)
4. Helps to increase disease resistance in crops and altering animal traits in plants and animals
5. Assists in classifying blood during screening before its transfused to another person.

Christian view of genetic engineering

Christians support genetic engineering that is beneficial to human beings e.g. Cure of genetic diseases, production of drugs, plant and animals

Human beings are made in Gods image and are loved by God with or without defects.

The dignity of the human being is eroded or disregarded and should be upheld.

Christians oppose cloning and test tube babies

Its against Gods will or teaching

Plastic surgery

Its to change or mould the shape of something, to enhance or restore an area of the body

Its repairing or improving of damaged, diseased or unsatisfactory shaped parts of the body with pieces of skin or bone taken from other parts of the body.

Skin grafting is the most common type of plastic surgery



Plastic surgery is done on cleft lips i.e. cosmetic surgery, breast surgery — reduction or enlargement, surgery done to look younger.

Reasons for plastic surgery

- ✓ It can help restore ones confidence or self — esteem
- ✓ It enhances beauty, attractiveness or youthfulness
- ✓ It enhances a persons life and can be a life changing procedure
- ✓ It may help a person to get a new job

Disadvantages

- ✓ Its expensive
- ✓ Can lead to transmission of diseases

Christian views on plastic surgery

- ✓ Some support it, as it has some benefits
- ✓ Some Christian oppose plastic surgery in order to look younger
- ✓ Some argue that some people do it because of a lack of self — acceptance, low self-esteem hence should work on such issues first.

The Christian view on the effects of modern science and technology on the environment (pollution, desertification)

In Genesis 1, man was given the responsibility of taking care of the environment

Ways of taking care of the environment

Cleaning up the environment, clean up rivers

Educating people on the importance of conservation

Dispose industrial wastes properly

Enforce use of environment — friendly fuel (unleaded fuel)

Factory owners to supply protective wear to factory workers

Planting of trees and flowers

Establishing airports, industries, and disco clubs away from residential areas.

Advocate for laws to be passed to minimize noise from vehicles, aircrafts,

Waste to be managed through

- ✓ Reuse e.g. bottles
- ✓ Recycle — plastic bottles old newspapers



- ✓ Recover — burning waste products to produce electricity

Pollution and its effects

Its introduction into the environment of substances or energy that is liable to cause hazards to human health, harm to living resources and ecological systems

Substances that because of pollution are called pollutants.

Some of the pollutants include; industrial effluent pesticides insecticides fertilizers ultra-violet rays from nuclear plants dust smoke noise waste heat exhaust gases from automobiles

Types of pollution

Water pollution

This is the increase of substances in water in excess of its rightful chemical components thus making it unsuitable for human, animal or plant use.

Disposing domestic and industrial waste into rivers, lakes, seas etc. pollutes water.

Disposing agricultural chemicals pesticides into water bodies.

Oil spilling into waters

Poor sanitation bathing or washing clothes in rivers or dams

Effects of water pollution

- ✓ Causes diseases, which are communicable such as cholera, typhoid, and dysentery.
- ✓ Leads to death of marine life — birds (Flamingo) fish by oil spills
- ✓ Mercury (metal) leads, silver is poisonous. They kill organisms.
- ✓ Water becomes unfit for human consumption

Air pollution

Presence of contaminants in the atmosphere caused by Smoke Fumes Dust from mines, quarries

When there is an increased level of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere that's pollution

Other major atmospheric pollutants include gases such as chlorofluorocarbons (CFC), and sulphur dioxide (SO₂)

Nitrogen Oxide (NO) i.e. fumes from vehicles, aircrafts and industries

Effects

- ✓ Leads to diseases such as bronchitis, asthma



- ✓ Leads to depletion of the Ozone layer leading to ultra — violent rays of the sun penetrating to the earth causing skin cancer, cataracts (eye problems) and low plant yields.
- ✓ Causes rusting of roofs
- ✓ Causes acid rains
- ✓ Carbon dioxide (CO₂) in the atmosphere has led to global warming.
- ✓ Formation of smog (thick fog), which can lead to accidents.
- ✓ (vii) Coloured rain due to large amounts of dust in the atmosphere
- ✓ Eyesight loss due to gas leakages from industrial plants.

Land pollution

Land pollution is any physical or chemical alteration to land, which causes change in its use and renders it incapable of beneficial use without treatment.

Improper or excessive use of insecticides, pesticides makes land acidic

Land is also polluted by improper disposal of waste / garbage, broken glasses.

Effects

Waste is an eye sore spoiling the beauty of the environment

Broken glass can lead to injuries

Open mining leaves pits, which are a danger to people and animals.

Noise pollution

Experienced especially in urban centres, near roads, running water, mining areas, airports, music from bars, nightclubs etc.

- ✓ Deafness, hearing problems
- ✓ Psychological disorders — frustrations, irritation
- ✓ Insomnia
- ✓ Shock due to sudden noise
- ✓ Cracking of walls

Noise can be minimized by

- ✓ Construction of sound proof buildings
- ✓ Location of residential areas away from industries, airports, bars, main roads



- ✓ Banning of unnecessary hooting, playing of loud music in public vehicles
- ✓ Installing silencers in generators
- ✓ Education people on the effects of noise pollution

Pollution caused by radiation

Mainly in developed countries

Atomic explosions e.g. Hiroshima / Nagasaki in Japan in 1945. The side effects of mutations of born children. Some children born with deformities. The radiation caused chromosome mutations. Some mutations on the cells of the parent / grandparents.

Nuclear power stations also a danger

Medical equipment e.g. Xray machines when one is over exposed to these radiations (x-rays) it can lead to development of cancer.

Desertification

Causes of deserts

1. Natural

- a) Persistent rains in a semi — arid area
- b) Exposure of an area to very high, very cold temperatures
- c) Inadequate rainfall for a long period of time

2. Human

Human activities that lead to desertification are

- (i) Cutting down of trees (deforestation) for land use such as building, industries, and not replacing them.
- (ii) Use of water from wells to irrigate land. Its harmful especially salty
- (iii) Incorrect use of pesticides and fertilizers destroy soil nutrients.
- (iv) Industrialization — industries emit carbon dioxide (CO₂) leading to formation of acid rain, which leads to unproductive land hence desertification
- (v) Overgrazing especially among the pastoralist communities
- (vi) Poor farming methods like cultivation on riverbanks and slopes, which causes soil erosion, leading to desertification.



Solutions to desertification

1. Removal of people, livestock from certain areas e.g. forests
2. Installation of good drainage systems
3. Reduction of water logging / salination
4. Use of alternative sources of fuel such as wind, solar, biogas
5. Advocate for penalties to those who pollute the environment — factories
6. Replace trees that are cut down
7. Build water storage facilities to store rain water then use it for irrigation
8. Educate people on the importance of the environment
9. Use of manure instead of harmful fertilizers